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Public Speaking

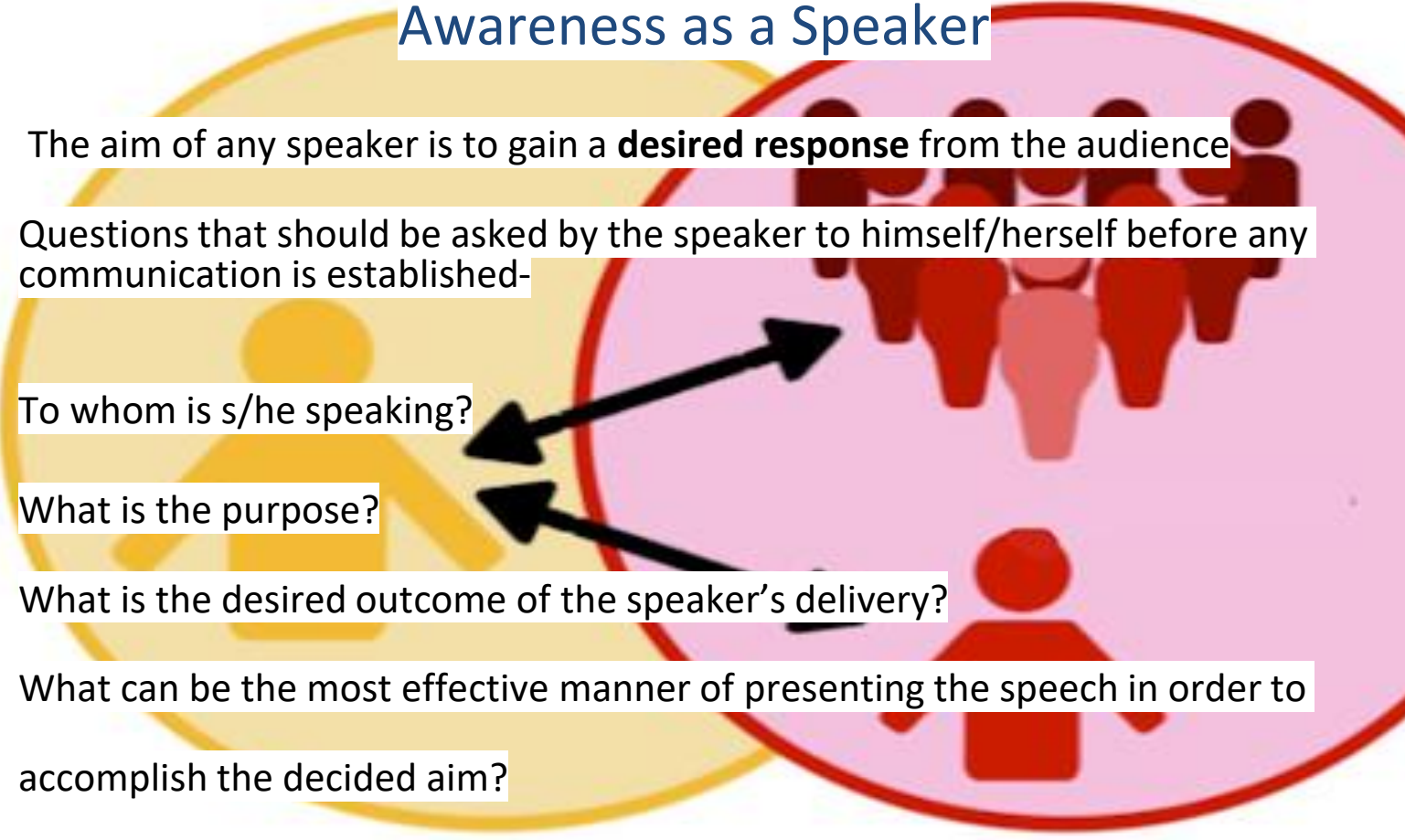
Lecture 07: Audience Awareness and Creating Credibility

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Awareness as a Speaker

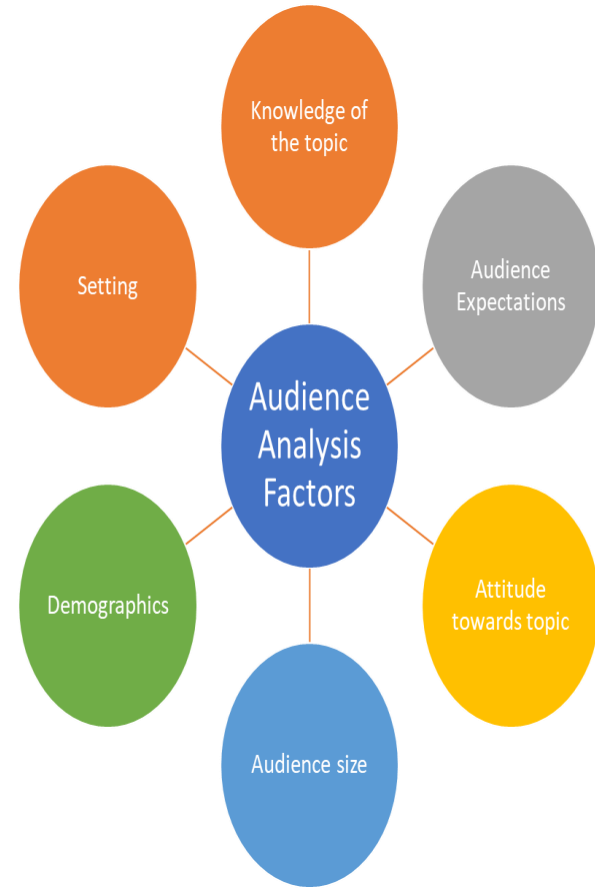
A Venn diagram with two overlapping circles. The left circle is yellow and contains a yellow silhouette of a person. The right circle is pink and contains a pink silhouette of a group of people. Two black arrows originate from the intersection of the two circles and point towards the four bullet points listed on the left side of the slide.

- The aim of any speaker is to gain a **desired response** from the audience
- Questions that should be asked by the speaker to himself/herself before any communication is established-
 - ☐ To whom is s/he speaking?
 - ☐ What is the purpose?
 - ☐ What is the desired outcome of the speaker's delivery?
 - ☐ What can be the most effective manner of presenting the speech in order to accomplish the decided aim?

Audience Analysis

A good public speaker knows the difference between “over-adapting” and “under-adapting” while taking audience preferences into consideration.

“There is a general agreement that a person who is a full member of a crowd... is likely to behave differently from the way he would behave if he were by himself.”(W.J. H. Sprott, Human Groups)



Awareness- A Conscious Space for Choice

- A speaker who is aware of the choices being made, takes into consideration all the following intricacies-
 - ☐ Selecting a topic
 - ☐ Determining a specific purpose
 - ☐ Settling on main points and supporting materials
 - ☐ Organizing message
 - ☐ Delivering the speech

Types of Audience

Supportive	• Aligns with the topic/ theme of the presentation - Reinforce
Emotive	• Seeks entertainment and connection through communication – Connect.
Directive	• Demands fact based speech and evidence to supplement the argument - Direct
Reflective	• Eager to form interaction and critically question/ express doubts. - Reflect

Classification of Audience

H.L. Hollingworth in his book, *The Psychology of Audience* :

- ❖ Pedestrian
- ❖ Discussion-passive
- ❖ Selective
- ❖ Concerted
- ❖ Organized

Demographics of Audience

Age.
Gender,
Education
Language,
Ethnicity
Culture
Attitudes & Values

Some Facts about Behavior in Group

- “Heightening of emotionality”
- “People in group have a reduced sense of responsibility.”
(W.J.H Sprott, Human Groups)
- ‘Group Size increases, member satisfaction decreases’ (A.P. Hare)
- Groups are collections of heterogeneous individuals.

Controlling Factors

- Variety
- Length of time concentration
- Time of the day
- Arousal and motivation

Content Creation with Audience Awareness

Step 1 - Prepare basic outline for the concerned talk/event.

Step 2 - Research on the type of audience.

Step 3 - Make the prepared outline focused with respect to the needs and interest of the audience.

Step 4 - Consider following to modify and strengthen yourself:

- ❖ Knowledge of the audience.
- ❖ Emotional state of the audience.
- ❖ Novelty/ Familiarity of the topic to the audience.
- ❖ Interpersonal relationship with the audience.

Stylistic Effect on Audience

- Irrespective of the novel content and solid argument, the style of a public speaker determines the captivating impact s/he has on the audience.
- A responsible orator would take care of following elements to appropriate their style with respect to the audience.
 - **Message:** with respect to audience's interests and needs
 - **Argument:** with respect to the need of strong evidence and narrative.
 - **Language:** with respect to the expected formality.
 - **Utterance** (Length and type): with respect to the time duration.
 - **Tone:** with respect to the interpersonal relationship.

Psychology of Audience

- It is essential for the speaker to make the audience **choose** to listen.
- Keeping the interest of the audience intact throughout is challenging.
- Response to any communication is not based entirely on what is spoken but especially on the **understanding of the audience.**
- The **basis of judgement** for the audience is what **they already know and believe.**
- The **message** should always be related to the audience- they should find it **as relevant as the speaker does.**

“ Without an audience women relapse and men become unkempt.”(Hollingsworth)

Patterns

Polarization
Interstimulation
Bipolar

Classmates as Audience

- Classroom is often considered as **artificial speaking situation**
- One can develop speaking skills within the classroom and can use it in the outside world
- Classroom can provide opportunity to inform and persuade same age group as well as elder people
- No immediate impact can mostly be registered but it can nourish one's speaking ability profusely



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Client as Audience



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- “Because it is what I like”- this is not a competent strategy
- Being Demonstrative is essential when dealing with client
- Know the difference between Prospect and Client

Addressing the Diversity

1. The talent of the speaker essentially relies in presenting the curated content in a polite and socially acceptable manner.
 - a. Recognize cultural filter of the audience.
 - b. Be aware of cultural gestures.
 - c. Use people-first language.

Example: Instead of saying “the deaf man”, say “the man who is deaf.” Focus is on the person rather than disability.

- a. Use euphemistic expressions.
- b. Gender neutral language.
- c. Practise politeness.

*“Know yourself
and
Know your Audience.”
-Tennessee Ernie Ford*

Thank You!

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